

DDI Specification: Current Status and Outlook

Wendy Thomas, Chair
Joachim Wackerow, Vice-chair
Technical Implementation Committee

Current Status

- DDI 3.1 was published 2009-10-18
 - Corrects a problematic URN structure
 - Corrects reported bugs found during first year
 - Provides consistant use of Name, Label, Description in line with ISO/IEC 11179-5
 - Established DDI version number structure
 - X.Y.Z
 - X is a major change bringing in new functionality
 - Y is minor BACKWARD INCOMPATABLE change
 - Z is minor backward COMPATABLE change
 - License change to LESSER GPL

BUG tracking

- Mantis bug tracker at
 - <http://mantis.ddialliance.org>
 - Login as “guest” to view bugs
 - Click on “View Issues” to see a full listing
 - New category under Product Version
 - “Future Versions” to capture ideas for future major version releases
 - report bugs to wlt@pop.umn.edu

TIC Activities

- Training – workshops and training materials
- Version 2.x
 - Address some specific requests for changes to 2.1 as well as provide better support for translating 2.1 to 3 and 3 to 2.1
- Standards mapping
- Increasing number of DDI trainers
- Increasing TIC membership

Topical Working Groups

- Survey Development Group (SDG)
- Controlled Vocabulary (CVG)
- Qualitative research
- Preservation
- Administrative/Register data

Additional Areas of Interest

- Response Scales (i.e., Likert scale)
- Preloads for dependent interviewing
- Capturing quality of test items/questions
- Relating Tasks with multi-question responses
 - capturing markup of Task content and hierarchical structure
 - capturing scoring (correct response varies)

Additional Areas of Interest cont.

- Longitudinal Survey
 - testing the standard
 - developing use cases and best practices
- Quality assessment
 - This may be based on national and international data quality frameworks such as DQAF (from the IMF) and similar European frameworks (Eurostat, OECD)

ddi-users@icpsr.umich.edu

Post new issues and questions
here!